

JIAQI (JACKY) YANG

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SUMMARY

PhD researcher (The Hong Kong Polytechnic University & University of Surrey) who combines large language models, machine learning and causal inference to measure behaviour from text and to estimate what actually drives outcomes. Builds LLM pipelines that run daily, check their own sources and are measured against test sets. Two Best Paper awards in 2026; papers under review at the leading journals in tourism research.

EDUCATION

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University & University of Surrey <i>Dual PhD, Hotel and Tourism Management / Surrey Business School</i>	Hong Kong SAR & Guildford, UK Sept. 2024 – Expected Sept. 2027
Shanghai University of International Business and Economics <i>M.Sc. in Applied Statistics — GPA 3.81/4.0, rank 5/111</i>	Shanghai, China 2022 – 2024
Shanghai University & University of Technology Sydney (joint programme) <i>B.Econ. in Finance (GPA 3.58/4.0) and B.Bus. (GPA 6.44/7.0)</i>	Shanghai, China 2017 – 2021

SKILLS

LLMs & AI	Gemini API, structured output, retrieval-augmented generation (BM25, vector, hybrid), tool-using agents, evaluation design, multimodal (video, image) extraction
Data science	Causal inference (difference-in-differences, event study, synthetic control), time-series and panel econometrics, forecasting, machine learning, NLP and sentiment analysis
Engineering	Python, R, Stata, SQL (SQLite FTS5), Git, GitHub Actions CI, automated testing, TeX
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native); English (IELTS 7.5)

SELECTED AI PROJECTS

filings-qa-agent — question answering over SEC filings <i>Python, Gemini, SQLite FTS5, numpy</i>	GitHub 2026
- Indexed 48 annual and quarterly reports of 12 large US companies; every answer sentence cites a source passage, and sentences citing passages the model was not shown are dropped automatically. - Evaluated keyword, vector and hybrid retrieval on 50 questions: BM25 95% correct, hybrid 90%, vector 70%; the system declined all 30 unanswerable question pairs. - Added a traced research agent that chooses between filings, price and news tools; 168 offline tests, CI and a key-free offline demo.	
finfluencer-digest — multimodal LLM research digest <i>Python, Gemini, GitHub Actions</i>	GitHub 2026
- Daily pipeline in which Gemini watches videos from 16 YouTube finance channels and reads X posts, extracts structured stock calls, aggregates consensus and disagreement, and emails a digest. - Multi-model fallback, a guard against dropped scheduled runs, and source-verified news links to prevent fabricated citations; 27 offline tests, CI and a demo mode.	
Open-source contributions <i>Python (FastAPI), TypeScript</i>	GitHub 2026
- Extended a local-first portfolio dashboard with broker account sync and a workspace that scores stock calls against later prices; four pull requests opened upstream. - Merged fix to the ClaudeCodeUsage VS Code extension. Also built a vision-model calorie tracker web app (24 releases in six weeks, calibrated against real weight data).	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University & University of Surrey <i>Doctoral researcher; AI and data in tourism and hospitality</i>	Sept. 2024 – present Hong Kong SAR & Guildford, UK
LLM text measurement at scale: co-developed LLM-based aspect-level sentiment measures from online reviews and tested how well they predict tourist demand (under review, <i>Journal of Travel Research</i>).	

- **LLM classification of corporate disclosures:** separated automation- from augmentation-oriented digital strategies in firm texts and estimated their different effects on performance (CHME 2026 Overall Best Paper Award).
- **Causal policy evaluation:** used the staggered rollout of visa and tourism-promotion policies as natural experiments to estimate effects on local housing markets (major revision, *Annals of Tourism Research*, corresponding author; IATE 2026 Best Paper Award).
- **NLP index construction:** built a firm-level green transformation index from annual-report text and evaluated China’s carbon trading pilots with difference-in-differences.

AWARDS

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| • Best Paper Award, International Association for Tourism Economics Conference (IATE 2026) | 2026 |
| • Overall Best Paper Award and Hospitality Management Track Best Paper, CHME 2026 | 2026 |
| • National First Prize, National College Student Market Research and Analysis Competition | 2020 |
| • National Second Prize, National College Student Statistical Modeling Competition | 2023 |
| • Outstanding Graduate of Shanghai Municipality | 2024 |

TEACHING & LEADERSHIP

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| • Teaching Assistant, Financial Management in Hospitality (PolyU): led three weekly tutorial sections, designed spreadsheet exercises, assessed group projects. | 2025 |
| • Moderator, panel “From Graduate to Scholar”, 21st Asia Pacific Forum for Graduate Students Research in Tourism. | 2025 |